

Every signal below ties to a public record & carries a confidence tag. Reported June 27, 2026. MED = real filing, multiple outlets agree, primary image pending direct-API pull.

| FIRST WORD, FROM THE FILINGS

THE SIGNAL

We read the public data the rest of the world ignores — and tell you what's coming before it's news.

ISSUE 001 · JUNE 2026 · a Brief Scout Media intelligence brief

THIS WEEK, FROM THE RECORD: SEC Form Ds · USPTO trademark filings · FCC authorizations · state WARN boards · building permits · customs data.
One rotation nobody's named, and nine signals that matter.

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Most media reacts to the announcement. **We read the filing that comes before it.**

Everything below is a real, recent public record — a layoff notice, a trademark, an FCC authorization, a permit, a customs aggregate — corroborated across multiple outlets, with a confidence tag and a source on every line. For investors, operators, journalists, and the relentlessly curious.

◆ LEAD SIGNAL · TRIANGULATION

Manufacturing's great rotation: the EV battery belt is laying off while defense factories can't hire fast enough

No single press release says this — but put the WARN notices next to the hiring waves and the picture is unmistakable. Skilled US manufacturing capital and labor are rotating out of EV/batteries and into defense production.

FADING	SK Battery America — ~958 jobs cut in Commerce, GA after Ford canceled the all-electric F-150 Lightning + the \$7,500 EV credit lapsed. MED-HIGH GM Factory ZERO — 1,300 idled at GM's flagship EV-only plant in Detroit-Hamtramck (a \$2.2B "electric future" conversion). HIGH BlueOval SK (KY) — battery-plant layoffs delayed/looming across the "battery belt." MED
BOOMING	Anduril "Arsenal-1" — 4,000+ jobs at a 5M-sq-ft drone/missile megafactory near Columbus, OH; opened ~3 months early, the largest job-creation project in Ohio history. HIGH Saronic — \$300M autonomous-warship shipyard in Franklin, LA, ramping after a \$1.75B Series D. MED

THE READ The 2021–22 battery-belt gold rush is unwinding in WARN filings state by state, while defense-tech is hiring *factory floor* — production engineers, techs, ops managers — by the thousand. The bet underneath the job reqs: the next war is won by whoever can mass-produce drones and hulls. Watch where the laid-off battery technicians land.

▸ src: fortune.com (SK Battery) · detroitnews.com / electrek.co (Factory ZERO) · jobsohio.com (Anduril) · techcrunch.com (Saronic)

■ SIGNALS THIS WEEK

Trademark tells

Wells Fargo filed "**WFUSD**" (serial 99693533; Cl. 9/36/42 — digital-asset trading, payments, tokenization), ~Mar 10, 2026. The #4 US bank is prepping a dollar-pegged stablecoin. MED · ► theblock.co, coindesk.com

Netflix filed into **dating & matchmaking** (serials 99707774 / 99707161, Cl. 9 + 45), Mar 17, 2026 — a category it has never been in, likely an app extension of its reality-dating IP. MED · ► justia / trademarkia

FCC authorization

Apple — model **A3577**, an unreleased "Bluetooth over-ear" device, surfaced in an FCC filing (test report dated May 5, 2026) with most exhibits under confidentiality. Read: a new **Beats** over-ear in the pipeline. MED · ► 9to5mac, macrumors, appleinsider

Breaking ground (permits)

Accton Technology — ~\$20M permit to build a **server-rack production line** in Mesquite, TX (AI/datacenter hardware on-shoring). MED · ► therealdeal.com

Carvana — \$65M facility permit in the Austin metro + a \$10M Jacksonville project. Back in physical-expansion mode. MED · ► therealdeal.com, jaxdailyrecord.com

Hiring tells

Walmart created an "**EVP of AI Platforms**" (reporting to the Global CTO), rolling agentic tooling to ~2M workers — agentic commerce moved from slide to org chart. MED-HIGH · ► axios.com, ciodive.com

FactSet named its first **Chief AI Officer** (Mar 2026) — the defensive tell of a structured-data incumbent staffing up before a startup agent-ifies its moat. MED · ► SEC 8-K

Just funded (Form D)

Avalanche Energy (Seattle compact-fusion) reported a fresh ~\$14.9M raise on top of a prior \$50M — reloading before any product PR. LOW-MED (secondary; EDGAR pull pending) · ► geekwire.com

▽ THE FADE · WHAT THE RECORD SAYS IS DYING

Spirit Airlines — a WARN notice for ~**4,857 Florida workers** (operations "permanently cease"), filed with only ~14 days' notice mid-Chapter 11. The notice is the obituary of a budget carrier killed by a fuel spike. HIGH · ► floridapolitics.com, dol.gov

Meta — 2,212 cut at Menlo Park (May 22 notice to CA EDD). "Efficiency" rebranded as AI reorg: cutting HQ headcount while racing to hire AI talent. MED · ► californiawarn.com

≈ PATTERN OF THE WEEK · THE CUSTOMS READ

Vietnam overtook China as the #1 US supplier of laptops and game consoles (Bloomberg's analysis of shipment-level customs data). But the bills of lading show the catch: Foxconn's Vietnam unit exported \$8.6B of devices while importing \$7.9B of components from China —

"Made in Vietnam" is mostly a final-assembly pass-through to dodge tariffs. Watch August BOLs: a Section 301 tariff switch is slated for late July. MED · ► [bloomberg.com](https://www.bloomberg.com)

THE SIGNAL PRO

The brief is the highlight reel. **Pro is the machine:** run the screens yourself, and set a standing alert on *any* company, category, or zip — get pinged the moment a new trademark, Form D, permit, FCC filing, or WARN notice hits. The intel desk that used to cost six figures, in your inbox. [\$XX/mo · sample]

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The Signal

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